PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

BeReal Passport & Community Boards

Prepared for: Product Leadership Review
Status: Revised after user testing — recommendation: refine, then retest
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Prototype: Live clickable prototype at lashawnfofung.github.io/BeReal-RealProcess

1. Executive Summary

BeReal Passport & Community Boards introduces optional, time-boxed Community Boards that give casual users an additional reason to open BeReal beyond their single daily photo. After taking their photo, a user may choose to post that same, unedited photo to a themed board (e.g. “Cramming” or “Coffee”). Doing so earns a collectible Real Passport stamp and adds the photo to a shared monthly capsule with their squad.

The goal is to increase Monthly Active Users (MAU) and daily engagement without changing what makes BeReal different: one real, spontaneous photo, no filters, no pressure. Nothing about the core capture mechanic changes, and every part of this feature is opt-in.

Update (v2.0): a clickable prototype was tested with a 5-person focus group in October 2026. Four of five testers said they would open BeReal more often, and the reminders and streak scored 4.2/5 for feeling low-pressure. The main friction was too many taps from capture to stamp. Recommendation: refine the flow, then retest with 7–10 people before an MVP.

2. Problem Statement

BeReal’s daily users fell from about 15 million to about 6 million in a matter of months. Research from a UI/UX teardown, competitor benchmarking and a user journey map surfaced three recurring pain points:

- Users often post once and forget to return — the feed goes quiet for the rest of the day.
- The one-photo format can start to feel repetitive over time, with no sense of shared occasion or ritual.
- There is no lightweight way for a friend group to rally around a shared moment without creating a group chat or event.

3. Feature Overview

The feature has five core pieces:

- Daily Theme Prompt — boards open at 12:00 AM in the user’s local timezone (“12:00 AM Community Board open!!”), and the Today screen shows a daily prompt. It is a fixed reset for tracking, not a timed post: users open the app whenever it suits them.
- Opt-in Board Posting — after taking their photo, users choose SEND (a regular post to My Friends, no stamp) or COMMUNITY BOARD (a themed post that earns a stamp). The board choice comes after the photo, so capture stays fast.
- Community Boards — a set of themed boards each month (October: HIKE, CRAMMING, COFFEE and HAUNTED, plus sponsored LITTLE WINS and GAME TIME), each with its own Real Passport stamp design.
- Capsule Carousel — the squad’s board posts collect into a shared, collage-style monthly capsule saved to Memories; squad members react with emoji, with no public like counts.

- Passport & Squad Stamp Tally — a personal BeReal Passport tab with the month's stamp gallery, and a squad leaderboard ranked by stamps collected.

A board stays open for its assigned month, then locks as a read-only memory capsule — it becomes a keepsake, not an ongoing treadmill.

4. Why This Stays True to BeReal's Values

Value	How the feature honors it
Authentic	The underlying post is identical to today's BeReal — no new content requirement, no filters, no retakes.
Opt-in, not mandatory	Regular (SEND) posting remains fully supported; boards are opt-in only, and nothing changes for users who don't join.
Light, not addictive	Stamps and the Squad Stamp Tally reward participation positively; there is no streak-loss or shame messaging.
Time-boxed	Boards close at month end and become an archive, not an infinite grind.

5. Goals & Success Metrics

Primary goal: increase MAU and daily engagement while preserving authenticity.

- North Star: DAU/MAU ratio (stickiness)
- Daily open rate (sessions per user per day); target 2.5x, to be validated in the MVP
- D7 and D30 retention
- % of daily posts tagged to a board (feature adoption)
- Taps and time from capture to stamped post (usability; added after testing)
- Passport / Squad Stamp Tally visit frequency (secondary engagement signal)
- Qualitative: user sentiment on whether the feature still "feels like BeReal"

6. Target Users

Full persona detail lives in the companion Case Study and User Journey. The design centers on one primary persona:

- Denise — an introverted first-time user who prefers low-pressure interactions, values privacy and feels friction with forced, real-time sharing.
- Casual and drifting users — occasional or rare BeReal users who need a better reason to post, not more urgency.
- Tested with: one daily user, two occasional users and two rare users (October 2026 focus group).

7. Key Requirements

7.1 Daily Prompt Engine

- Compute the live boards and today's prompt per user's local timezone; boards open at local midnight (12:00 AM).
- Single, capped, dismissible nudge when boards open — no repeated badgering. Re-engagement hooks invite rather than pressure: a reminder bubble ("3 friends already posted to CRAMMING today"), a soft streak cue with no loss framing, and a come-back banner.

- The prompt engine must resolve which board(s) are live on a given day — flagship boards run all month, but shorter-run boards (a single day or a week) can be active in parallel; see 7.3.

7.2 Capture Flow

- After the photo, show a post-type choice: SEND (random post to My Friends, no stamp) or COMMUNITY BOARD (themed post + stamp). The board choice comes after capture, so taking the photo stays as fast as today; users are never auto opted-in.
- If COMMUNITY BOARD: the user picks one active board (the card turns from grey to white and its lock opens), then taps "Stamp & post to [BOARD]." States: loading ("Stamping your passport.."), success ("Stamp earned! Added to [BOARD] board 🎉") and error ("That didn't go through. Let's try again." — the photo is kept).
- Reduce taps from capture to stamped post, the top finding from testing; set a target in the Phase 1 retest.

7.3 Community Boards

- Each board has a configurable duration — Month (flagship), Week, or Day — set at creation. Multiple durations can run concurrently within the same month.
- Up to four themed (month-long) boards run per month, plus sponsored boards that unlock on their start date, each with a name and its own Real Passport stamp design.
- Shorter-run boards (single-day or single-week) can layer on top for observances or weekly rituals after full rollout; they are not shown in the prototype.
- Boards lock when their duration ends; locked boards are browsable but accept no new posts.

October example (as shown in the prototype) — themed boards run all month; sponsored boards unlock on their start date:

Board	Duration	Type
HIKE	Month	Themed
CRAMMING	Month	Themed
COFFEE	Month	Themed
HAUNTED	Month	Themed
LITTLE WINS	From 10/15/2026	Sponsored
GAME TIME	From 10/20/2026	Sponsored

7.4 Social Interaction (MVP)

- Squad members react to board posts with emoji (😍 😂 🔥 👏). Reactions stay inside the squad, with no public like counts; capsule board details show 👍/👎 totals.
- Open question: comments are not in the prototype. If added, reuse the existing comment and moderation stack.

7.5 Passport & Squad Stamp Tally (MVP)

- Passport: a BeReal Passport tab showing the month's stamp gallery, with locked entries for boards not yet posted to; new stamp designs launch every month, including sponsored ones.
- Squad Stamp Tally: ranks squad members within the existing friend graph by stamps collected, with a quick link to the capsule carousel ("View October Capsule Carousel").
- A lightweight version of both ships in the Phase 2 MVP alongside a single board, so the full loop — post, stamp, browse, react, rank — can be tested end to end from day one.

7.6 Settings & Opt-out (MVP)

- Settings → Features adds “Opt-in - Community Board” and “Opt-out - Community Board” rows, which open a per-board ON/OFF list.
- Only current boards can be changed; past months stay in Memories as capsules. Turning every board off returns the Today screen to the opt-in state.

7.7 Sponsorship Hook (Phase 4 pilot, not MVP)

- Data model reserves an optional sponsor field per board (name, logo, tagline); the prototype shows sponsored boards and stamps as a concept only. No ad-serving logic ships in the MVP.

8. Non-Goals / Out of Scope for MVP

- No paid sponsorships or ad-serving in the MVP — data model support only (sponsored boards are a Phase 4 pilot).
- No public leaderboard — the Squad Stamp Tally stays within each user’s squad.
- No changes to the core once-daily BeReal notification or capture mechanic.
- No new moderation model; comments stay out of scope until the open question in 7.4 is resolved.

9. Prioritization (RICE)

Indicative scoring for roadmap discussion — updated after the October 2026 focus group; to be refined with retest and MVP data.

Factor	Rating	Rationale
Reach	High	Daily prompt is visible to any user who opens the app; broad exposure across the base.
Impact	Medium-High	Adds a new, repeatable engagement loop without touching the core photo mechanic.
Confidence	Medium	Directional signal from a 5-person focus group (4 of 5 would open BeReal more often); not yet validated at scale.
Effort	Medium	Front-end heavy (prompt UI, capture toggle, board/capsule/leaderboard screens); backend needs timezone-aware scheduling, a board/stamp data model, and support for configurable board durations (day/week/month).

10. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Gamification feels performative or off-brand	Keep stamps invisible unless opted in; never surface “you didn't post today” shame messaging.
Notification fatigue from the daily prompt	One capped, dismissible nudge; user can disable in settings.
Increased moderation load from board comments	Reuse the existing moderation and reporting pipeline; no new system required.
Low adoption of opt-in tagging	Use soft social proof (“3 friends already posted to CRAMMING today”) rather than penalizing non-participants.

Risk	Mitigation
Complexity — too many taps from capture to stamp (top testing finding)	Cut taps from capture to stamp, make SEND vs. COMMUNITY BOARD clear, add a first-use explainer, and retest with 7–10 people.

11. User Testing Results (October 2026)

A 40-minute, in-person focus group with five participants (one daily, two occasional and two rare BeReal users) completed three tasks in the clickable prototype while thinking aloud, then took an eight-question survey.

- 4 of 5 said they would open BeReal more often.
- Reminders, streak and leaderboard scored 4.2/5 for feeling low-pressure, the highest score.
- Launch decision: 3 yes · 1 maybe · 1 no.
- Key findings: it brings back occasional users; the capture-to-post flow had too many taps; the stamps and Passport were the draw; the risk was complexity, not pressure (the non-user called it “less authentic and overly complex”).
- Recommendation: refine, then retest. Keep the concept; cut taps from capture to stamp, make SEND vs. COMMUNITY BOARD clear, add a first-use explainer, and keep the hooks as they are.

12. Rollout Plan

- Phase 0 (complete): clickable prototype and 5-person focus group test.
- Phase 1: refine the flow (fewer taps, clearer post type, first-use explainer) and retest with 7–10 people, including more non-users.
- Phase 2 (MVP): ship one board with the full loop — opt-in, stamped posting, capsule, squad reactions, Passport and Squad Stamp Tally — to one friend-group cohort; measure adoption and DAU/MAU lift.
- Phase 3: full rollout — four themed boards per month, plus shorter day/week observance boards (see 7.3).
- Phase 4: pilot sponsor-branded boards as a monetization test, subject to brand-safety review.

13. Prototype Reference

A live, clickable HTML prototype demonstrates the seven-screen habit loop — Today, Capture toggle, Board select, Post confirm, Capsule / Board details, Passport & Leaderboard, and Settings / Opt-out — including empty, loading, success and error states (lashawnfofung.github.io/BeReal-RealProcess). An interactive job aid walks users through the same screens.

14. Design Assets Checklist

Production assets design will need to create or supply, separate from engineering work:

- Board background art — a distinct visual pattern/illustration per board (flagship and short-run), used behind the photo collage.
- Passport stamp — the stamp graphic applied to a board post, plus a per-board variant (e.g. a Cramming stamp vs. a Coffee stamp).
- Passport screen — the personal stamp-collection grid, including a locked/greyed state for boards not yet joined or already archived.
- Squad Stamp Tally — rank list styling, including treatment for top ranks vs. standard rows.

- Capsule carousel — a compelling, browsable way to move between current and archived boards (e.g. swipeable capsule cards), for both the live board feed and the past-boards gallery.

15. Ask

We are requesting approval to run the Phase 1 refine-and-retest round (7–10 testers, including non-users, measuring taps and time on task) before committing to the Phase 2 MVP and further engineering investment.

16. Revision History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	September 2026	Initial draft for leadership review, before user testing.
2.0	October 27, 2026	Updated after the 5-person focus group. Retitled to BeReal Passport & Community Boards; author, status and version added. Boards, post types (SEND / COMMUNITY BOARD), squad-only reactions and the Squad Stamp Tally aligned to the prototype; persona updated to Denise. Added 7.6 Settings & Opt-out, 11 User Testing Results, the taps-to-post metric and the complexity risk. Rollout re-phased (refine and retest before MVP); RICE confidence and the Ask updated.